ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE B

Vote No on Measure B.

Merced families are already struggling under the weight of high inflation, rising grocery bills, expensive utilities and gas prices. Measure B is a **forever tax**. Forcing residents to pay extra on everyday items forever is a **regressive financial burden** that drains millions of dollars directly out of our local economy and the pockets of households that can least afford it.

True community safety does not happen in a vacuum. It requires stable housing, robust youth programming, shared green spaces, mental health support, and economic opportunities.

Just 2 years ago, the new Measure C imposed another sales tax with 95% of its revenue dedicated to Police and Fire. **And now this Council is back asking for more money for Police and Fire.** This is a spending and priority failure. The City historically and continues to allocate more than 75% of its General Fund budget to Police and Fire. **This new tax measure is disingenuous** and will continue to **funnel another $16M annually from our community** to Police and Fire. As a general sales tax, there is no guarantee that this tax revenue will go to parks, youth investment, or street repair.

Demand that this City makes real investments into community safety and builds a Merced for all residents.

Vote NO on Measure B.

It is time our City to invest in community needs.

/s/ LaTanya Richard, Community Member
/s/ Adam Shane, Nurse, Parent, Community Member
/s/ Marilyn Sobel, Community Member, Retiree
/s/ Jasmine Diaz-Shane, Parent, Community Member, Independent Contractor
/s/ Fue Xiong, Councilmember